

ANI

"THE BJP-RSS NARRATIVE THAT WE ARE CORRUPT IS FALSE. THERE IS A MISUSE OF CENTRAL AGENCIES. MEDIA, JUDICIARY ARE UNDER PRESSURE TOO"

playing together. We implemented the Old Pension Scheme, which other states are following. We will pass a law to guarantee that it won't be abolished. We also presented a special budget for farmers and, before even the Supreme Court ordered it, announced Rs 40,000 compensation for every head of cattle lost to lumpy cow disease. We have been building industrial areas in every block and 25-30 are completed. I brought in the MSME Act, which means you need not approach the government for five years for any clearances once you set up your venture.

Q. Does the state government have enough resources to implement the new schemes, or the 'Gehlot guarantees'?

A. Governments work by taking loans. It is all about finance management, which we have done well. The Centre's debt was Rs 60,000 crore when the NDA came to power, but now it is Rs 1.55 lakh crore in nine years. Modiji announced five kg of grains, something that we are already giving. Their governments in MP, UP also offer such benefits; UP even gives laptops. But we imposed no tax during our five years and I have been asking Modiji for a social security law that covers India.

Q. The BJP's main campaign against you is that corruption is rampant in the state.

A. The BJP and RSS have tried to build this narrative that me and my MLAs are corrupt even when we are not. Had our MLAs been corrupt, they would have accepted Rs 10 crore as the first instalment to oust me in 2020. But they are not corrupt.

Q. There are ED/ IT raids against your ministers, officers, even a case against your son Vaibhav.

A. There is today an absolute misuse of central agencies; even the media and judiciary are under pressure. This is not a happy situation. The case against Vaibhav was raised a decade ago by the BJP, but there is no evidence of any wrongdoing by him.

Q. The Opposition says there is a failure in law and order. They point to a rise in crime, especially against women, and the question paper leaks in the state service examinations.

A. When it comes to crime, we have passed a law with a provision for life imprisonment to anyone found involved in leakage of examination papers. Also, I ordered that every FIR must be registered and investigated instead of cops turning away complaints and forcing people to go to courts to get an FIR registered. Now, the cases registered via the courts have come down.

Q. The BJP alleges that you practise Muslim appeasement and cite the case of the beheading of a tailor in Udaipur after which no